

Week 6: Monotheism

BIG IDEA

Monotheism is more than the claim that one God exists: it is the view that a single, personal, all-powerful Creator has made himself known. In Exodus 6 God reveals himself to Moses as Yahweh, a covenant-remembering, redeeming God who pursues his creation, which sets up everything Christianity will claim.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- In Exodus 6 God tells Moses that Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob knew him as God Almighty, but not by his name, the Lord.
- The name Yahweh, 'I am who I am,' reveals God's personal nature, his holiness, and a covenant becoming more real than before.
- Having covered naturalism (the West) and pantheism (the East), the case for Christianity must first show a single, personal, all-powerful Creator exists.
- Monotheism is a worldview containing Judaism, Christianity, and Islam; it means leaving the buffet and ordering the most consistent, coherent dish off the menu.
- God is not a creator who walks away; he is actively engaged in history, redeeming and chasing after his image-bearers even after we screwed it up.
- That personal, pursuing God sets up what Jesus does, the Holy Spirit, and the Trinity; coming weeks build the case that Christianity within monotheism is true.

SCRIPTURE

Exodus 6:1-5

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What changes between knowing God as 'God Almighty' and knowing him by name as Yahweh?
2. What would it look like to view the world as if one personal God cares about and pursues you individually?
3. How would a monotheistic worldview change your thoughts on morality, justice, love, and how you act at school?
4. How could Christians looking through this lens actually influence the culture, rather than just being influenced by it?

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